GLOBAL INTELLIGENCE

Evening Update

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What Changed Today

- **Oil falls to a 10-week low:** Brent closed at $92.21 a barrel, down 6.2%, and WTI at $86.35. The FT tied the fall to Trump calling strikes on Iran "highly unlikely". ANSA cited possible progress in the Middle East. No Iran deal is confirmed.
- **Nvidia scandal deepens:** The shares fell as much as 8.8% on Monday, at one point erasing nearly $400bn of market value (Japan Times). CEO Jensen Huang had disclosed his affair with a woman reported to be a suspected Chinese spy. The Nasdaq 100 still closed up 3.4%, led by AMD's 13% jump.
- **France blames Iran for the freezer attacks:** Paris says the October cyberattack on supermarket refrigeration was carried out by Shahid Kaveh, a unit of Iran's Revolutionary Guards (IRGC). Some of the attacks caused fires. France summoned Iran's ambassador.
- **Ukraine talks restart under heavy fire:** US-brokered talks with Russian and Ukrainian envoys are due to begin Tuesday. President Zelensky warns that Russian strikes on the Dnipro bridges aim to split the country in two. EU foreign policy chief Kallas says Moscow is "pretending" to negotiate.
- **Italian banks surge:** Milan gained about 2.6%, the best performance in Europe. Banco BPM rose 10% after Crédit Agricole's offer, and UniCredit rose 6%. The BTP-Bund spread tightened to 103 basis points.
- **Anthropic IPO size surfaces:** Reuters, citing a filing, says Anthropic is aiming to raise up to $69.3bn. That would rank among the largest listings ever.
- **Saudi pipeline hit:** The FT reports an attack on Saudi Arabia's East-West crude pipeline, a key export route that avoids the Strait of Hormuz.
- **US inflation test:** US consumer price data are due Tuesday, with Treasury yields in focus. The US 10-year yield was 4.86%.

Contents

Europe & Italy 2
World 3
Markets Close 4
Technology, Defence & Space 5
Overnight & Tomorrow 5
Markets Dashboard 7

Europe & Italy

Milan leads Europe as banks rally, spreads narrow

Piazza Affari closed up about 2.6%, the best performance in Europe, on the credit sector (ANSA). Banco BPM rose 10% after Crédit Agricole's offer. UniCredit gained about 6% on its results. The BTP-Bund spread fell to 103 basis points, with the 10-year BTP yielding 4.29%. The euro was strong and Eni weakened with oil. Dutch TTF gas fell 3.9% to €82.2/MWh.

Why it matters: Crédit Agricole, already the largest shareholder in Banco BPM, is pushing to combine it with its Italian arm. The sector is consolidating quickly.

Watch: Terms of the offer and the Italian government's stance.

Sources: ANSA, ANSA spread

France blames Iran's Revolutionary Guards for fridge cyberattacks

In the first attribution since the October attacks, French authorities named Shahid Kaveh, an IRGC cyber unit previously linked to attacks on US water-utility controllers. Foreign Minister Barrot called the attack unprecedented, and the ambassador was summoned. The attacks spoiled food and, in some cases, caused fires.

Why it matters: This is a state-level attribution for an attack on civilian infrastructure. Il Sole 24 Ore notes that the pro-Russian groups Z-Pentest and NoName057(16) had claimed the attacks on European fridges. The US Justice Department says Z-Pentest was founded and directed by Russian military intelligence (GRU). The claims are not reconciled, and attribution remains contested.

For Europe & Italy: Italy's own cyber debate is heating up. The opposition says the government is cutting €15m a year from the national cybersecurity strategy fund. The majority says the money goes to defence.

Watch: Whether Paris announces sanctions. Interior Minister Piantedosi's security committee meets Tuesday.

Sources: The Record, Handelsblatt, Il Sole 24 Ore, ANSA

Meloni advances a gas-plant reimbursement to cut power bills

Italy moved ahead with a plan to reimburse gas-fired power plants for part of their fuel costs, Bloomberg reports. Premier Giorgia Meloni wants to limit the effect of high energy prices before next year's general election.

Why it matters: In Italy gas sets the electricity price much of the time, so lowering the plants' cost aims to lower wholesale power prices. The cost is expected to appear elsewhere, for example in charges on bills, and the final details are not confirmed.

Sources: Bloomberg

Italy's public finances: audit court warns on one-off revenue

The Corte dei Conti says 70% of revenues are temporary, which will weigh on future budgets. ANSA reports that the EU has approved flexibility. The insurers' association Ania says insurers are discriminated against and wants the measures changed.

Sources: ANSA

Germany adds €3bn to the 2027 budget

Finance Minister Klingbeil made late changes. The Federal Employment Agency gets a larger loan, and there is more money for electric-car buyers (Handelsblatt).

Sources: Handelsblatt

Disinformation and migration

An EU report says a covert Russian network exploited recent French riots on social media. A separate assessment found accounts linked to Israel and to the US MAGA movement tying the riots to radical Islam and migration. At least 39 migrants died when a Europe-bound boat sank off Senegal. Thirteen died off Crete, and 18 Sudanese were rescued. In Turin, the occupation of the Campus Einaudi ended.

Sources: Japan Times, BBC, BBC Crete, ANSA

World

Russia and Ukraine: talks resume while Russia targets bridges

A new round of US-brokered talks is due to start Tuesday. Russian and Ukrainian envoys are expected to discuss ceasefire monitoring and territory. It is the first such round since February, when talks were paused as Washington turned to the Iran war (Japan Times). India held high-level calls with both Moscow and Kyiv as it seeks a bigger role (Bloomberg).

On the ground, Zelensky says Russian strikes on the Dnipro bridges aim to cut Ukraine in two, severing power and transport links with the east (FT). Kallas said Russia is "pretending" to negotiate while "bombing civilians". The Economist argues Trump is in a hurry for peace and Putin is not, so the talks may help Russia prolong the war.

Why it matters: The bridges are the main routes for moving troops and supplies across the Dnipro. Without them the east becomes hard to supply.

Watch: Whether a ceasefire-monitoring format is agreed.

Sources: Japan Times, FT, Bloomberg, Japan Times, The Economist

Middle East: oil drops, but the pipeline is hit

Oil hit a 10-week low after Trump said strikes on Iran were "highly unlikely". Meanwhile the FT reports an attack on Saudi Arabia's East-West pipeline. The Houthis and Iraqi militias have repeatedly threatened it. The EU is also offering money for a response to Black Sea attacks, while Washington weighs Turkish and Indian proposals for safe passage (Politico).

Sources: FT, FT oil, Politico Europe

United States: a Miller-led White House

Trump named Stephen Miller chief of staff, replacing Susie Wiles, days after Republicans' midterm defeat. He took over on 9 November (White House). Former Pence aide Marc Short said the move helped change the headlines. The Nvidia affair has also drawn in Washington.

Sources: White House, Bloomberg

China and Asia: debt and tech stress

China Water Environment, one of the nation's largest sewage-treatment firms, is seeking to restructure about $410m of offshore loans (Bloomberg). Two chip suppliers, Suzhou Denglin and Jiangsu Xinde, list in Hong Kong on Tuesday after raising $301m. Handelsblatt says China's AI stocks are falling. Indonesia is marketing a second yuan-denominated "panda" bond despite the threat of an MSCI double downgrade. Qantas will outsource 850 jobs, mostly to India.

Sources: Bloomberg, Bloomberg, Bloomberg, BBC

Africa

Nine Zimbabweans were caught allegedly trying to leave South Africa to fight for Russia. Ukraine says hundreds of Africans have been recruited. Botswana will double its stake in De Beers, with Namibia and Angola joining the Gareth Penny consortium (FT).

Sources: BBC, FT

Latin America

Colombia is negotiating about $15bn from the IMF as its finances strain. October inflation was 6.30%, lower than forecast. ExxonMobil signed a memorandum of understanding with Venezuela toward operating oil fields, months after calling it "uninvestable". Mexico's central bank chief said the surprise rate cut was a one-off.

Sources: Bloomberg, Bloomberg, Bloomberg

Markets Close

Oil and AI chips drove the day. The quote feed's figures for the continental European indices appear to predate Monday's rally, so they are not used here.

- **Europe:** Milan rose about 2.6% on banks, and ANSA described Europe as positive. The BTP-Bund spread tightened to 103 basis points and the 10-year BTP yield was 4.29%. TTF gas fell 3.9% to €82.2/MWh, with Brent falling in parallel.
- **US:** The S&P 500 rose 2.35% to 7,549.94 and the Nasdaq 100 rose 3.40% to 27,907.62. AMD jumped 13% as the AI-chip trade revived. Nvidia had slid as much as 8.8% intraday. The VIX fell 22% to 19.92.
- **Rates and currencies:** The US 10-year yield was 4.86% and the 2-year 4.78%. EUR/USD rose 0.69% to about 1.12 and the dollar index fell 0.59% to 101.70.
- **Commodities:** Brent fell 6.2% to $92.21, down 12% on the week, and WTI fell 4.9% to $86.35. Gold rose 1.4% to $4,132 and copper rose 2.5%. Bitcoin was about $74,758.
- **Asia (last session):** The Nikkei rose 5.35% and Taiwan's Taiex rose 8.2%, though both are well down on the week.

Tomorrow: US CPI is the main test, since a hot print would challenge the Treasury rally. Oil is exposed to Iran headlines and the Saudi pipeline. Exposed sectors are banks, energy and AI chips. The euro depends on the dollar's direction. This is a description, not advice.

Sources: ANSA, ANSA oil, Bloomberg, Bloomberg

Technology, Defence & Space

Nvidia: from scandal to export-control risk

Huang's disclosed affair with a suspected Chinese spy is unproven. Bloomberg Opinion's Gautam Mukunda argues that mutual US-China espionage is routine. He says the bigger concern is evidence that Nvidia chips reached China in violation of export controls. Handelsblatt asks about consequences for the stock and for China's AI boom.

Why it matters: Nvidia dominates AI chips, so governance and export-control questions reach the whole sector. AMD's 13% jump shows investors looking for alternatives.

Sources: Japan Times, Bloomberg, Handelsblatt

AI money and politics

Anthropic is aiming to raise up to $69.3bn in its IPO, according to Reuters citing a filing. Altimeter Capital, an investor in OpenAI and Anthropic, is targeting a $2.5bn late-stage fund plus an $800–900m fund. Scott Wiener, who wrote California's advanced-AI safety legislation, won Nancy Pelosi's seat and could shape federal AI policy (MIT Technology Review).

Sources: Bloomberg, Bloomberg, MIT Technology Review

Cyber

Beyond the French attribution, Ukraine's cyber police arrested four people, including the alleged leader of scam call centres, over a $5m crypto fraud targeting Germans. Vanderbilt University reported a cyberattack affecting campus devices and systems.

Sources: The Record, The Record

Defence

A firm is proposing "Arctic Hunter", a 56-metre fishing trawler stripped of its fish-processing gear and fitted with autonomy features to track Russian submarines (Defense News).

Sources: Defense News

Space

NASA launched the AMPERE Challenge for US firms to demonstrate 3–7 kW Hall-effect thrusters, and opened applications for its next astronaut class.

Sources: NASA

Overnight & Tomorrow

- **Asia overnight:** Suzhou Denglin and Jiangsu Xinde list in Hong Kong, a test of demand for Chinese tech. Watch Nvidia-linked names in Taiwan, Korea and Japan after their large swings.

- **US inflation:** The key CPI report is due Tuesday. It will shape expectations for the Federal Reserve and the Treasury rally.
- **Ukraine talks:** The US-brokered round begins Tuesday, reportedly in Abu Dhabi on 10–11 November, with two senior EU officials attending. Watch the Dnipro bridges.
- **Italy:** Piantedosi's national security committee meets over the hacker threat. Watch Banco BPM and Crédit Agricole's next steps.
- **Iran and the Gulf:** Any US-Iran deal language, plus the Saudi pipeline damage.
- **Nvidia:** The board investigation and any congressional or Justice Department moves.
- **Coming up:** The reported Xi-Trump meeting at APEC in Shenzhen on 18–19 November. China's extra 24% tariff stays suspended until January.

Markets Dashboard

Europe	Last	Day	Week
Euro Stoxx 50	6,170.49	-0.98%	+0.64%
FTSE MIB (Italy)	50,053.00	-0.90%	+1.12%
DAX (Germany)	25,820.36	-1.92%	+0.01%
CAC 40 (France)	8,139.00	-0.81%	+2.13%
IBEX 35 (Spain)	19,369.50	-0.60%	+3.84%
FTSE 100 (UK)	10,673.90	-1.01%	-0.52%

Americas	Last	Day	Week
S&P 500	7,549.94	+2.35%	+0.11%
Nasdaq 100	27,907.62	+3.40%	-0.29%
VIX (US volatility)	19.92	-22.31%	-5.82%
Bovespa (Brazil)	172,236.05	+2.22%	+2.57%

Asia	Last	Day	Week
Nikkei 225 (Japan)	60,506.08	+5.35%	-4.40%
CSI 300 (China)	4,065.79	–	–
Hang Seng (Hong Kong)	24,495.76	+0.06%	+4.71%
KOSPI (South Korea)	5,232.04	+3.41%	-10.70%
Taiex (Taiwan)	42,961.15	+8.21%	-4.36%
Nifty 50 (India)	25,044.65	+0.06%	+6.84%

Rates	Last	Day	Week
US 10Y yield (%)	4.8640	+0.10%	-0.61%
US 2Y yield (%)	4.7750	+0.00%	+0.00%

Currencies	Last	Day	Week
EUR/USD	1.1225	+0.69%	+0.29%
EUR/GBP	0.8346	+0.03%	+0.00%
EUR/CHF	0.9198	+0.68%	+0.40%
EUR/CNY	7.4598	+0.24%	+0.26%
US Dollar Index (DXY)	101.70	-0.59%	-0.05%
USD/JPY	158.03	-0.16%	+0.07%
USD/CNH	6.6680	–	–
USD/RUB	82.66	+0.87%	+1.74%
USD/INR	93.90	-0.59%	-1.06%
USD/BRL	5.5085	+0.09%	+1.33%
USD/TRY	50.22	+0.19%	+0.47%
Bitcoin ($)	74,757.85	+0.23%	-7.02%

Commodities	Last	Day	Week
Brent ($/bbl)	92.21	-6.21%	-11.99%
WTI ($/bbl)	86.35	-4.93%	-10.48%
Dutch TTF gas (EUR/MWh)	82.33	–	–
Gold ($/oz)	4,132.00	+1.40%	+4.09%
Silver ($/oz)	53.20	+2.70%	+4.89%
Copper ($/lb)	6.3735	+2.50%	-2.60%
Wheat (c/bu)	591.50	+0.04%	-2.47%

Delayed exchange quotes, last daily close (Yahoo Finance). Prices, not policy facts.

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